Dr. Felix Otto

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Research Interests

Sports economics, behavioral economics, applied econometrics, data science

Academic Positions

2022–present **Postdoctoral Researcher in Sports Economics**
Department of Sport Economics, Sport Management and Media Research, Institute of Sports Science, University of Tübingen

2017–2022 **Research Assistant**
Department of Sport Economics, Sport Management and Media Research, Institute of Sports Science, University of Tübingen

Education

2022 **Dr. rer. soc.**, University of Tübingen (summa cum laude)
Thesis: *How trust in fairness and national identity affect the behavior of spectators and judges in sports*
Supervisor: Prof. Dr. Tim Pawlowski

2013–2017 **M.Sc. Sport Management**, German Sport University Cologne
Semester abroad (2015): Victoria University, Melbourne, Australia

2010–2013 **B.A. Sport Management**, University of Potsdam

Publications

Peer-reviewed journal articles

Political relations and sports: Exploring the demand for relocated soccer games
with Georgios Nalbantis and Tim Pawlowski. *European Sport Management Quarterly*, 24(1), 159–177, 2024. [DOI]

Nationalistic bias among international experts: Evidence from professional ski jumping
with Alex Krumer and Tim Pawlowski. *Scandinavian Journal of Economics*, 124(1), 278–300, 2022. [DOI]

Trust in fairness, doping, and the demand for sports: A study on international track and field events
with Tim Pawlowski and Sonja Utz. *European Sport Management Quarterly*, 21(5), 731–747, 2021. [DOI]

"Germany crashes out of World Cup": A mixed-method study on the effects of crisis communication on Facebook
with Tim Pawlowski and Sonja Utz. *Journal of Sport Management*, 35(1), 44–54, 2021. [DOI]

Animation intensity of sponsorship signage: The impact on sport viewers' attention and viewer confusion
with Christopher Rumpf. *Sport, Business and Management: An International Journal*, 8(2), 177–194, 2018. [DOI]

Books

Integrität im Sport: Forschungsstand zur Prävention von integritätsgefährdenden Phänomenen
with Christian Deutscher, Finn Spilker, and Tim Pawlowski. Springer VS (essentials), 2026. [DOI]

Working Papers

Varying reference-point salience
with Alex Krumer and Tim Pawlowski. [arXiv]

Trimming of extreme votes and favoritism: Evidence from the field
with Alex Krumer and Tim Pawlowski. [arXiv]

Discussion Papers

A comment on" Private health investments under competing risks: Evidence from malaria control in Senegal"
with Kenneth Colombe, Martin Kroczek, and Mukesh Kumar. The Institute for Replication (I4R), I4R Discussion Paper Series 331, 2026. [EconStor]

Work in progress (Selection)

Gender and nationalistic bias
with Alex Krumer and Tim Pawlowski

Performance-enhancing drugs in economic competitions
with Svenja Toepsch, Christian Deutscher, and Tim Pawlowski

Grants and Funding

2024–2025 **Integrity in Sports** ("Integrität im Sport"), Federal Institute for Sports Science (BISp), project PR020240400083
PIs: Felix Otto, Tim Pawlowski, and Christian Deutscher

Presentations (from recent years only)

2026 VfS Annual Conference (Innsbruck); 17th ESEA Conference on Sport Economics (Zurich); 3rd Workshop on Sports, Economics, and Natural Experiments (Stirling); 15th Sport Economics Symposium (Innsbruck)

2025 THE Workshop (Hohenheim); 27th German Sport Science Conference (Münster); 16th ESEA Conference on Sport Economics (Innsbruck); The Behavioral Workshop (Ulm); 28th Annual Meeting of the German Association of Sport Economics and Sport Management (Koblenz)

2024 Workshop on Sports, Economics, and Natural Experiments (Zurich); Workshop on Fairness in Sports (Ghent)

Teaching

Institute of Sports Science, University of Tübingen

Master level (M.Sc. Sport Management)

2021–2026 **Empirical Research Seminar (Sport Management Research)**, project seminar

2020–2026 **Applied Sport Management**, project seminar; including supervision of student teams in the International Olympic Case Study Competition

2020–2022 **Sport Media and Communication: Sport Media Reception and Digitalization**, seminar

Bachelor level (B.Sc. Sports Science, profile Sport Management)

2023/24 **Introduction to Working and Study Techniques**, seminar

2020–2021 **Conception, Organisation and Evaluation of Sports**, seminar; International Sport Management Game in collaboration with Hanze University of Applied Sciences Groningen

2018–2020 **Behavioral Sports Economics**, seminar

2017–2020 **Sport Sponsorship-Linked Marketing**, seminar

Supervision

- 14 Master's theses (M.Sc. Sport Management, M.Ed. Economics)
- 19 Bachelor's theses (B.Sc. Sport Management)

Professional Activities

Refereeing Activities

Journal of Behavioral and Experimental Economics, *The American Statistician*, *International Review of Economics*, *Journal of Sports Economics*, *Sports Economics Review*, *European Sport Management Quarterly*, *International Journal of Sport Finance*, *International Journal of Sports Marketing and Sponsorship*, *International Journal of Sport Policy and Politics*

Other

- Invited speaker at the Studium Generale "Sports Cultures, Performance, and Diversity" (Center for Gender and Diversity Research, Institute of Sports Science, University of Tübingen, 2026)
- Organizer, Workshop on Integrity in Sport, Frankfurt, 2024
- Contributor, Berlin Replication Game, Institute for Replication, 2025
- Member, European Sport Economics Association (ESEA)

Media Coverage (Selection)

- *The Economist*: "How to detect nationalism in winter-sport judges" (2022)
- *Le Devoir*: "Critique de la faculté de juger aux Jeux olympiques", interview (2022)
- *The Weekly Sports Piece* podcast: interview and paper discussion (2022)
- *Der Spiegel*: "Ein primitiver menschlicher Instinkt" (2020)